

Australia Daily Brief

Saturday, October 10, 2026

1,792 words · 7 min read

RE: Hanson savages Taylor at CPAC · Bowen rules out Russian diesel · PNG police get K23m of K442m election budget · Cook Islands PM back from Pre-COP31 · NZ teal wave enters campaign

ASX 200

8,717

+0.40%

AUD/USD

0.6988

+0.52%

NZX 50

13,749

+0.50%

NZD/USD

0.5612

-0.09%

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• TODAY AT A GLANCE

- 1 Pauline Hanson called Angus Taylor a "smarmy management consultant" at CPAC Australia in Brisbane and urged attendees to put One Nation first, while Taylor conceded the Coalition "got some things wrong" on net zero and immigration.
- 2 Chris Bowen said Australia does not "need or want Russian fuel" after Donald Trump announced a deal to buy Russian diesel, arguing Moscow should not be rewarded for its invasion of Ukraine.
- 3 Papua New Guinea's police force has received K23 million of the K442 million it sought for the 2027 national election, with the parliamentary elections committee chairman demanding the Chief Secretary halt an estimated K200 million in hire-car spending.

• TOP STORIES

AU-POLITICS

Hanson calls Taylor a "smarmy management consultant" as CPAC crowd heckles Liberal leader

Pauline Hanson told the Conservative Political Action Conference in Brisbane that attendees should not trust the Coalition, urging them to put the Liberals or Nationals second behind One Nation on their ballots.

Angus Taylor, billed as keynote speaker and heckled from the floor, said the Coalition "got some things wrong" in signing up to net zero and increasing immigration, and framed the next election as a "spiritual fight" for the soul of the nation. It was the first address to the conference by a sitting Liberal leader.

per Guardian Australia (Josh Butler): "'Smarmy management consultant': Angus Taylor criticised by Pauline Hanson and heckled at CPAC event" · also SMH

AU-FOREIGN-POLICY

Bowen rules out Russian fuel after Trump strikes diesel deal with Putin

Energy and climate change minister **Chris Bowen** said Australia did not "need or want Russian fuel" and that Russia "should not be rewarded for their illegal and immoral invasion of Ukraine", speaking as he updated reporters on Australian fuel reserves. **Donald Trump** publicly thanked **Vladimir Putin** for the deal. Brent crude settled at *104.72*, up 4.39 percent on October 9.

per Guardian Australia (Josh Butler): "Australia does not 'need or want Russian fuel', Chris Bowen says, after Trump deal to buy diesel from Putin" · also Bloomberg

PACIFIC-POLITICS

PNG police receive K23 million of K442 million sought for 2027 election

Deputy Commissioner Administration Dr **Philip Mitna** told the Permanent Parliamentary Committee on Elections on October 9 that the Royal PNG Constabulary has received *K23 million* of its *K442 million* budget submission for the 2027 National Elections. The committee held a follow-up inquiry in Port Moresby the same day into election preparations.

per PNG Post-Courier: "Police only got K23m of K442m Election Budget"

• OVERNIGHT

PACIFIC-POLITICS

Bird demands whole-of-government directive to stop K200 million election hire-car bill · PNG Post-Courier

Permanent Parliamentary Committee on Elections chairman **Allan Bird** told the Chief Secretary to issue a whole-of-government directive requiring the use of government-owned vehicles for the 2027 National Elections. Bird put the alternative cost of hire cars at an estimated *K200 million*.

PACIFIC-DIPLOMACY

Brown returns from Pre-COP31 with message that "the Pacific is not waiting" · Cook Islands News
Prime Minister **Mark Brown** wrapped up a week at the Pacific Pre-COP31 meetings in Tuvalu and Fiji, saying the message belongs as much to families at home as to world leaders: the Pacific is not waiting to be told help is coming. The ABC reported the United Nations climate meeting was hosted jointly by Fiji and Tuvalu.

AU-DEFENSE

War Memorial, RSL and Legacy press Canberra to release Iraq and Afghanistan histories · ABC News
The Australian War Memorial, the RSL and Legacy have agreed on a "concerted effort" to force the release of official histories of the Iraq and Afghanistan wars, written several years ago but not cleared for publication by government. Ex-service organisations describe the delay as having "negative consequences" for veterans. Australia's involvement in Afghanistan will be marked at a national commemorative service on Sunday.

AU-POLITICS

UAE investigators trace alleged hijacker's radicalisation to his student years in Melbourne · ABC News
United Arab Emirates authorities said the co-pilot accused of trying to crash a flydubai aircraft into Ben Gurion Airport began a "drift towards extremism and terrorism" while studying in Australia nearly ten years ago, reading extremist literature and following content glorifying terrorist organisations. The Australian Federal Police is investigating his time in Australia. The Indian captain,

Smit Machchhar, unlocked the cockpit door during the attack, allowing passengers aboard the flight carrying more than 170 people to regain control.

TRADE-ECONOMY

Darwin council to lead trade delegation to Guangzhou and Ho Chi Minh City in December · ABC News
Lord mayor **Peter Styles** will take about ten businesses to China and Vietnam in December, at a cost of about \$18,000 in ratepayer funding, the council confirmed. General manager of innovation **Alice Percy** said it was "definitely not a junket" and the first council-led delegation abroad since 2023, coming after rates rose above inflation and the annual hard rubbish collection was deferred to 2027.

• STAT OF THE DAY

K23m

PNG police funding received of a K442m election request

Deputy Commissioner Philip Mitna told the parliamentary elections committee the Royal PNG Constabulary has received about five percent of what it sought for the 2027 national election.

PNG Post-Courier

• PACIFIC WIRE

COOK ISLANDS · COOK ISLANDS NEWS

Te Ipukarea Society calls for deep-sea mining moratorium on economic grounds

The environmental group urged the government to assess the economic risks of commercial seabed mining alongside technical and environmental concerns, citing a new report. The Cook Islands seabed authority said on October 6 that exploration runs to 2032.

FIJI · FBC NEWS (FIJI)

Rubio marks Fiji's 56th independence day, praising its regional contribution

United States Secretary of State **Marco Rubio** sent congratulations to Fiji on its national day, acknowledging what he called Fiji's important contribution to the region. The message lands a day after Fiji demanded US evidence behind China-linked bribery sanctions.

VANUATU · VANUATU DAILY POST

Fifteen bills listed for Vanuatu's November ordinary parliamentary session

Vanuatu's parliament will consider 15 bills when it convenes for its November ordinary session. A separate Child Care and Welfare Protection Bill is also headed to parliament.

VANUATU · VANUATU DAILY POST

Departing Japanese envoy Okuda pledges continuity in Vanuatu-Japan ties

Okuda bid farewell in Port Vila with a commitment to maintaining relations between Vanuatu and Japan. Vanuatu's last recorded external security pitch in this brief's tracker was Finland's maritime surveillance and disaster technology offer on September 26.

PAPUA NEW GUINEA · PNG POST-COURIER

Marape calls for private power investment as K263 million Ramu transmission project completes

Prime Minister **James Marape** called for large-scale private sector investment in electricity generation across Papua New Guinea following completion of the *K263 million* Ramu Transmission System Reinforcement

Project in Lae. JICA is listed among the project partners.

VANUATU · VANUATU DAILY POST

Erakor youth leader carries community climate experience to Pre-COP31 in Nadi

Didier Ben, youth president of the Erakor Youth Bridge Association, attended the Pre-COP31 event in Nadi at the invitation of the Vanuatu Association of NGOs, visiting two Nadi communities facing river erosion during a four-day visit. VANGO chief executive **Shirley Abraham** said grassroots leadership "was not about speaking perfect English".

PAPUA NEW GUINEA · PNG POST-COURIER

Aitape Port redevelopment launched in West Sepik

The Aitape Port Redevelopment Project was officially launched on October 9 in West Sepik Province. Minister for State Enterprises **William Duma**, PNG Ports and Kumul Consolidated Holdings are listed among the parties.

REGIONAL · RNZ PACIFIC

US warning centre clears Pacific islands after Panama earthquake

The US tsunami warning centre said there was no further tsunami threat to Guam, the Commonwealth of the Northern Marianas, and American Samoa following a Panama earthquake. The Australian reported the quake at magnitude 7.7.

PAPUA NEW GUINEA · PNG POST-COURIER

Central and Gulf provinces break deadlock on Papua LNG tier-one benefits split

Member for Hiri-Koiari **Keith Iduhu** congratulated the Central and Gulf provincial governments on finalising an 80 to 20 tier-one benefits split for the Papua LNG project, ending what he called a longstanding deadlock.

• NEW ZEALAND

NZ-POLITICS · CANBERRA TIMES

Opportunity leader Qiulae Wong emerges as potential kingmaker in NZ campaign

First-time candidate **Qiulae Wong**, the 38-year-old leader of Opportunity, is cast as a decisive actor in New Zealand's national election, scheduled for November 7 with advance voting opening October 26.

NZ-POLITICS · RNZ

NZ First pledges minimum wage rises of at least inflation

New Zealand First has committed to lifting the minimum wage by at least the rate of inflation if it returns to government. The pledge follows the party's list release, which placed new names ahead of sitting MPs.

CHINA IN THE PACIFIC

REGIONAL · OTHER · GLOBAL TIMES STATE MEDIA

Chinese official says Beijing never treats island nations as an arena for major-power rivalry

A Chinese official said China and Pacific Island countries uphold mutual respect and that Beijing does not treat the islands as a theatre of great-power competition. Forum chair **Surangel Whipps Jr** used near-identical language on September 24, telling the region it is "not a theatre for geopolitical competition".

REGIONAL · OTHER · CHINA DAILY STATE MEDIA

China Daily runs Pacific Islands "lessons" from Long March legacy

Chinese state media published a feature framing the Long March as a source of lessons for Pacific Island countries, part of a continuing run of party-history messaging aimed at the region.

• CANBERRA POLITICS

AU-POLITICS · SMH

Taylor billed as CPAC keynote, received as Hanson's support act

Pauline Hanson's supporters were moved to tears at the Conservative Political Action Conference in Brisbane, a reception the Sydney Morning Herald contrasted with the one given to the Liberal leader. The conference is the first a sitting Liberal leader has addressed.

AU-POLITICS · ABC

Hastie defends Coalition migration plan against charge it copies One Nation

Shadow Minister for Industry and Sovereign Capability **Andrew Hastie** was asked whether the Coalition's new migration policy, which would cut international student numbers and shift weight to skilled migrants, simply reproduces **Pauline Hanson's** position. ABC finance presenter **Alan Kohler** assessed the plan against Labor and One Nation proposals.

AU-POLITICS · ABC

Universities Australia chair says student cap below 25 percent would close regional campuses

Professor **Carolyn Evans**, chair of Universities Australia and vice-chancellor of the University of Melbourne, told the ABC that the Coalition's plan to cut international students to below *25 percent* could mean major job losses and the closure of regional campuses.

AU-POLITICS · SMH

Albanese presses on with social media strategy after podcast gaffe

Anthony Albanese is continuing a social media push aimed at reaching voters in a fragmented media environment, returning to comedy content after an earlier podcast misstep.

TRADE-ECONOMY · THE AUSTRALIAN

ACTU warns of above-inflation wage claims under new leadership

The Australian Council of Trade Unions signalled it will pursue above-inflation pay claims under its new leadership. Trimmed mean inflation remains above the Reserve Bank's target band, with the cash rate held at 4.35 percent in August.

• BUSINESS AND ECONOMY

TRADE-ECONOMY · ABC

Firmus float valued at \$44 billion collapses, ABC puts a number on the deal

ABC reporting valued the abandoned Firmus Technologies listing at *\$44 billion*, describing it as what would have been the largest Australian Stock Exchange launch this century. The company, which builds AI data centres in Tasmania and Asia, pulled the float this week.

TRADE-ECONOMY · SMH

Rinehart's Andean copper and gold push meets local resistance

A company controlled by Australia's richest woman is pursuing copper and gold in the Andes, where local communities want no part of the project, the Sydney Morning Herald reported.

• UPCOMING

OCT
26

Advance voting opens for the New Zealand general election

Fixes the point from which the Luxon coalition's record is locked in for most voters.

NOV
7

New Zealand general election

Determines whether the National, ACT and NZ First coalition continues, and with it Wellington's defence and aid settings.

NOV
2026

Vanuatu parliament's ordinary session, with 15 bills listed including the Child Care and Welfare Protection Bill

Sets the legislative agenda in Port Vila for the rest of the year.

DEC
3

Scheduled US firing-squad execution of Nidal Hasan, which the Pentagon says will be livestreamed

Amnesty International Australia is pressing Canberra to raise it with Washington, putting a consular and human rights item into the alliance channel.

DEC
2026

Darwin City Council trade delegation to Guangzhou and Ho Chi Minh City

A subnational Australian trade mission to China at a time of continued federal scrutiny of PRC commercial links.

• THE WIRE

US-CHINA-PACIFIC

PACIFIC ISLAND TIMES

Pacific Islands Forum's goals, achievements and failures

Gabriel McCoard writes that US Deputy Secretary of State **Christopher Landau** attended the 55th Pacific Islands Forum meeting in Palau from August 31 to September 4 and later travelled to Chuuk, despite the United States not being a full member. The column notes **Donald Trump** referred to the Federated States of Micronesia and the Marshall Islands as "U.S. territories" in a Truth Social post shortly before the meeting, and that China's July 6 ballistic missile test arced across the Pacific.

PACIFIC-POLITICS

ABC PACIFIC

Pacific Review: Samoan PM apologises over historical Nazi salute

ABC Pacific reported Samoa's prime minister apologised over a historical Nazi salute, alongside an ABC investigation into how Solomon Islands MPs access overseas medical treatment and calls for a Papua New Guinea investigation into mass fish deaths in Western Province.

VANUATU DAILY POST

Vanuatu minimum wage review proposes sector-specific rates

A review of Vanuatu's minimum wage has proposed sectoral wage rates rather than a single national floor.

FIJIVILLAGE

Sex video posted to Fiji cabinet minister's Facebook page, then removed

A sex video appeared on a Fijian cabinet minister's Facebook page before being taken down, with the public urged not to share it. Fijivillage did not name the minister.

FIJIVILLAGE

Fiji police internal affairs to question officers over Lautoka arrest

Internal Affairs will question police officers over an arrest in Lautoka. It follows the charging of three Fiji police officers with the murder of a fellow constable, reported on October 9.

AU-FOREIGN-POLICY

ABC

Fifty years on, China is not taking official stock of the Cultural Revolution

ABC Saturday Extra marked 50 years since the end of China's Cultural Revolution, noting that officially Beijing is not revisiting the decade of mass violence and political upheaval.

• ANALYSIS AND OPINION

THE SATURDAY PAPER

The 'pure rاتفuckery' between Minns and Albanese

The Saturday Paper reports on the breakdown in the working relationship between **Chris Minns** and **Anthony Albanese**. Only the headline and framing are available in the collected text.

Argument: Relations between the New South Wales premier and the prime minister have deteriorated into open hostility.

CSIS Australia Chair

AUSTRALIA DAILY BRIEF

Washington, D.C.

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